

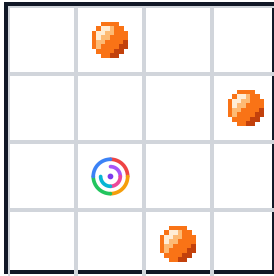


GOBBLE

SIMULTANEOUS-PROGRAMMING SNAKE · 2-6 PLAYERS · ~20 MIN

Everyone programs their moves **in secret**, then all the snakes move **at once**. Eat to grow. The longer your snake, the more points it's worth!

What's in the box



Mini-board: one per player. Food spots and special swirls are **printed**, so they never run out.



Your hand: 6 movement tiles plus your own permanent boost (left, in your colour). Spare gold boost tiles come from a shared stack at growth milestones.

Each player gets:

- **6 movement tiles** in their colour. Rotate one to aim it.
- **1 personal boost tile**, always theirs, back in hand every round.
- **A player board** with ten boxes that hold their snake sticks. The number under each box is their score.
- **A snake head and 13 wooden sticks** in their colour.
- **A score marker.**

Shared:

- **6 mini-boards** (4×4). Every board's food layout is different, and none of them look the same rotated, so turning a board changes the game. Four boards also carry a **special space**.
- **Boost stack:** spare ×3 boost tiles taken at growth milestones. They're all identical, so they sit face-up in a stack.
- **18 Special cards:** 9 effects, 2 copies each, shuffled into a face-down deck.
- **Score track.**
- **Snake food:** yellow glass beads, left behind when a snake dies.
- **A 10-second sand timer.**

The icons at a glance



Food spot
printed · +1 segment, +1 point



Special space
printed · draw a Special card



Snake food
a token from a death · +2 segments · pick it up once eaten



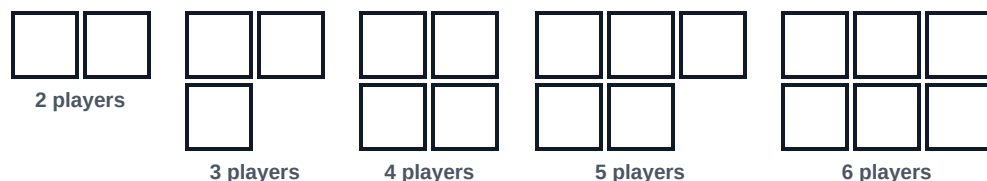
Head
leads the snake · the point shows which way it faces



Body segment
leaves snake food behind when you die

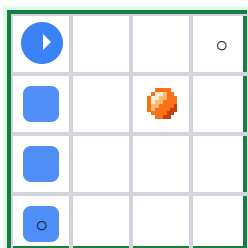
Setup

- 1 **Build the board.** Put out one mini-board per player, packed as close to an even square as possible. Any outside edge is a **wall**, including the notch where a board is missing.
- 2 **Player setup.** Each player takes their **6 movement tiles**, their **personal boost tile**, their **snake head** and a **player board**, then fills all ten boxes on that board with their wooden snake sticks. Shuffle the **Special cards** into a face-down deck; leave the spare **boost tiles** face-up in a stack, since they're all the same. Put every score marker off the track at 0.
- 3 **Place snakes** at length 4 (see below), in any order you like.

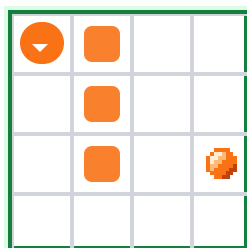


Placing your snake

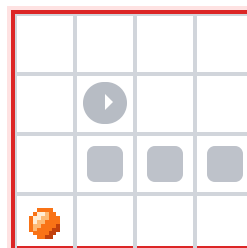
Your snake is a **head plus 3 segments** on 4 **contiguous** cells, straight or bent. At least one of them has to **touch a corner of any mini-board** (the ringed cells below). The head goes on one end and points away from its neck. You can cover printed food, but **you never eat what you cover**.



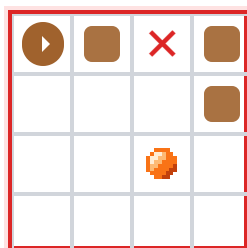
Legal: the tail end sits on a corner cell.



Legal: bends are fine, and the head is on the corner.



Illegal: nothing touches a corner.



Illegal: the cells are not contiguous.

Respawning works exactly the same way. A snake that died comes back next round at length 4, on any 4 contiguous cells touching a board corner, avoiding snakes and snake food. If **no corner placement is available at all**, place as close to a corner as you can.

Playing a round

1 • Program, in secret

Lay **2 to 6 tiles** face-down in a row in front of you. The leftmost resolves first. Every tile points a direction, so rotate it to aim. If you lay fewer than 6, your snake **stops in place** for the rest of the round.

- A **movement tile** moves your head **1 space** the way it points.
- A **boost tile** moves your head **3 spaces** the way it points. It works exactly like a movement tile, just further. Your personal boost comes back to you every round; spare boost tiles go back to the stack once used.



Four programmed moves: up, up, a **boost** pointing right (3 spaces), then right. The last two slots are empty, so the snake stands still.

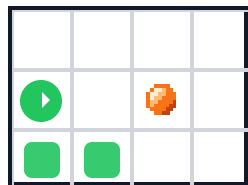
🕒 **The panic timer.** The instant the **first** player finishes their row, start the 10-second timer. When it runs out, everybody else locks **whatever they have**, finished or not. Program fast to hustle your opponents!

2 • Reveal and resolve, one slot at a time

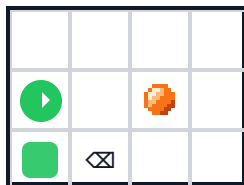
Flip every row face-up. Resolve slot 1 for everyone, then slot 2, and so on. Inside a single slot:

- 1 **Boosts slide first.** Every boosting snake moves its full 3 cells, one cell at a time, together.
- 2 **Then movement tiles.** Every stepping snake moves 1 space, all at the same time.

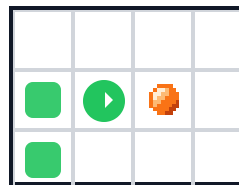
And each individual move happens in this order:



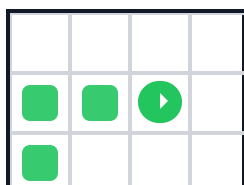
a. Before the move.



b. **Tail clears.** Lift your last segment, unless this move is going to grow you.



c. **Head slides** one cell, and the lifted segment fills the gap behind it.



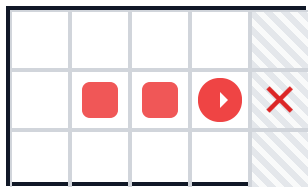
d. **Eat.** Landing on food adds a segment and scores a point. The printed spot stays put for next time.

3 • End of the round

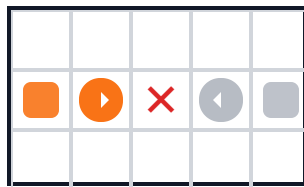
There is **no upkeep**, because the food is printed on the boards and never needs replacing. Respawn anyone who died, check whether anybody has hit the target score, and program the next round.

Crashing

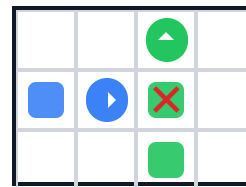
You die if you move into a **wall**, into a space **another snake moves into at the same time**, or into a **snake's body or the side of its head**. Heads point a direction, so their sides count just like a body. It makes no difference whether the other snake moved this slot or stood still. The red X marks where the crash happens.



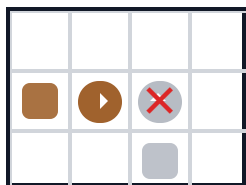
Wall. The board edge kills you, and so does the hatched gap where no board was placed.



Same space. Two snakes moving into one space at the same time: **both die**.

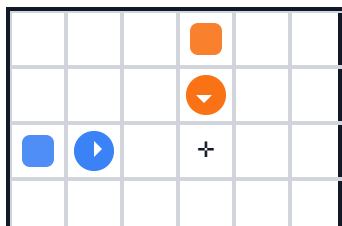


Body. Blue drives into green's middle. **Only blue dies**, green is untouched.

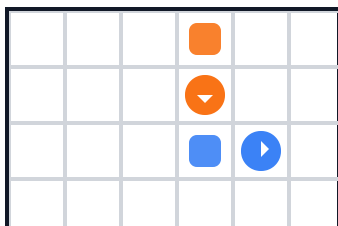


Side of a head. Brown hits silver from the side, so **only brown** dies, whether or not silver moved.

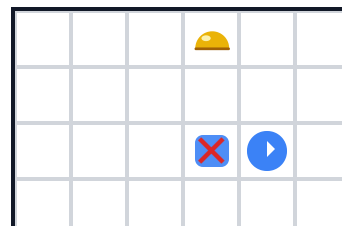
Boosts go first. A boosting snake crosses a contested space **before** a stepping snake reaches it, and leaves its body sitting in the way.



1 • Before. Blue plays a **boost** (3 cells right). Orange plays a single move down. Their paths cross at the marked space.



2 • The boost slides first, straight across orange's path. Blue's **body** now fills the crossing space.



3 • Then the steppers move. Orange moves down into blue's body and **dies**, leaving snake food behind. **Blue is unharmed**.

A boost is checked cell by cell: if it crashes on the 1st or 2nd cell it dies there and never finishes the slide.

Eating & growing

YOU ENTERED	GROWTH	ALSO	NOTES
 Food spot	+1 segment	+1 point	Printed, so it never runs out . A snake sitting on it just blocks it.
 Special space	—	draw a Special	Printed on 4 of the 6 boards. Also never runs out.
 Snake food	+2 segments	+2 points	A yellow bead left by a death. It's a token , so pick it up once eaten.

New segments appear **behind the head** and unspool as you move. Anything that doesn't grow you resolves like a normal move, with your tail piece filling the gap.

Growth milestones: boxes **3, 6 and 10** on your player board have a 🏹 printed inside them. The moment that stick comes out, take a **boost tile** from the stack. You may hold at most **6** spare boost tiles (your personal one is always on top of that).

Your player board

Ten upright boxes, each holding one of your wooden snake sticks at setup. **Every time you eat, take a stick out** and add it to your snake. The number under the box you just emptied is your score. Boxes **3, 6 and 10** have a boost icon printed inside, revealed as that stick comes out.

1

2

3
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4

5

6
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7

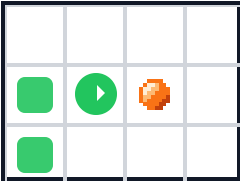
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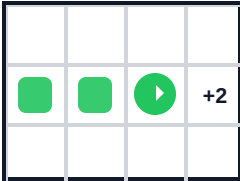
10
🏹

ten growth steps · the gold box is maximum length

You always have points equal to how far your snake has grown, so dying never takes them away. It's easiest to move your marker when your snake dies, but you can tick each food off as you eat if you prefer. The total comes out the same. Once the **last stick is out** you're at maximum length: your snake stops growing and every food you eat is worth **2 points** instead (snake food is worth 4).



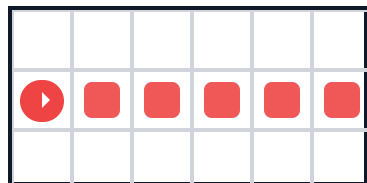
A maxed snake about to eat...



...doesn't grow, and scores +2 instead. The food spot is still there for the next pass.

Dying

- 1 **Record your score** if you haven't been ticking it off as you ate: the number under the last box you emptied, plus 2 for every food eaten at maximum length. The points are already yours, and dying doesn't take any away.
- 2 **Leave snake food.** Your head leaves the board. Put a **yellow bead** on **every other body segment**, starting with the first one behind the head, and remove the segments in between. Each bead is worth **×2 food** to whoever eats it.
- 3 **Refill your player board** with all ten sticks, and **respawn** next round at length 4, touching a board corner (see Setup).



A red snake at length 6, about to crash.



Its **2 points** are already scored. It leaves **3 beads of snake food**, one on every other segment, and the rest go back in the box.

Winning

The moment anybody reaches **30 points**, the game ends immediately. Everyone's score is already up to date, so just compare totals and the **highest wins**. *Ties*: the tied player with the longest snake takes it. If they're still tied, share the victory.

Special cards

Crossing a swirl lets you draw one Special. Each card says when you may play it. Cards that last a round are **discarded at the end of that round**. If the deck runs out, shuffle the discards into a new one. If two specials ever collide, resolve them in **player order, starting with whoever flipped the timer last**.

-  **Flip Flop** · BETWEEN ROUNDS
Swap your head and tail. Your snake now runs the other way.
-  **Vroom Vroom** · WHILE PROGRAMMING
All of your boost tiles move +1 extra space this round.
-  **Bounce** · WHILE PROGRAMMING
If you would crash this round, put your head on your tail instead and keep going.
-  **Rev Up** · ANY TIME
Take 4 boost tiles from the stack.
-  **Victory Lap** · WHILE PROGRAMMING
At the end of this round, score points equal to your length, or nothing if you are dead.
-  **Whoopsie** · BEFORE RESOLVING
Rotate one of your single movement tiles before it resolves.
-  **Nom Nom** · WHILE PROGRAMMING
Every snake food bead you eat this round grows you +1 extra.
-  **Star Power** · WHILE PROGRAMMING
Colliding with another snake's head doesn't kill you this round, unless they also played Star Power.
-  **Careful Slither** · WHILE PROGRAMMING
When a boost tile resolves this round you may move only 2 spaces instead of 3.

Quick reference

- 1 **Program** 2–6 tiles face-down. Movement moves 1 space, boost moves 3, both the way the tile points. Your own boost always comes back.
- 2 The first player to lock starts the **10-second sand timer**. Everyone else locks whatever they have when it runs out.
- 3 **Resolve slot by slot**: boosts slide first, then all steppers move together. Tail clears, head slides, check crashes, eat.
- 4 **Food** gives +1 segment and +1 point and never runs out. A **swirl** draws a Special. **Snake food** gives +2 segments and +2 points. Boxes 3, 6 and 10 give a boost tile. At **maximum length** every food is worth **2 points**.
- 5 **Crash** means death. Your points are already yours. Leave snake food on every other segment, refill your board, and respawn on a corner.
- 6 **First to 30** ends it, and the highest total wins.

Three habits of a good Gobbler: program a safe pair of moves before you program a greedy one, watch which rivals still hold boost tiles, and never let a fat snake wander somewhere it can't turn around.